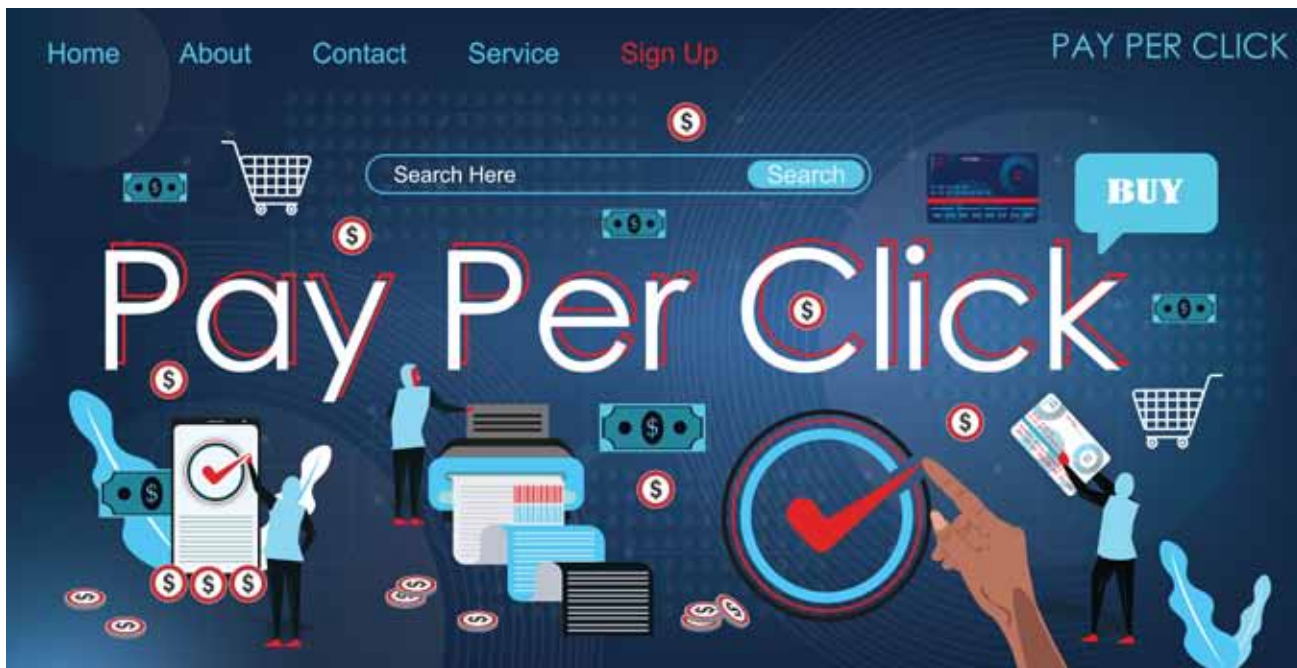




fic to the analytics platforms.”

“How’s that possible?”

“The folks they depute will click on the client’s URL, go to the landing page, spend some time there, and then click on a couple of links further, so that bounce rate is low, and time-spent-per-user is decent.”

“Wow, five options! This is unbelievable.”

“I think I have one more... How about we run ads on other platforms, such as Facebook, with the client’s URL being the CTA for these promotions?”

“While this would cost us, we could profit from the arbitrage - the fee we have charged the client and the amount we will need to pay Facebook.”

“But won’t clicks via Facebook cost us as much as what the client is paying us? Else, why would the client pay us and not Facebook?”

“They want to target our *niche* audience, but if we target *generic* audience in Facebook and generate clicks from them, the cost per click would be super low, and the client won’t know.”

“And those clicks will get count-

ed as part of our campaign?”

“Yes, they will.”

“Are you sure that we can generate clicks at a lower cost via Facebook?”

“Oh yes! Facebook is great at generating clicks for any type of promotion. They seem to have users who are happy to click on ads, even when these are not meant for them.”

“While this client does not have a UTM code, if they had, would they have been able to know that we are generating clicks from a platform other than the one they paid for?”

“No.”

“Awesome! We’ve done some ground-breaking innovation today by compiling six ways to boost the clicks for our customers and make them happier about their RoI.”

“Let’s keep this a secret. Else our competitors may also use them to beat us at this game.”

Shhhhhh.

Nutshell: Only conversions matter

Impressions, clicks and click-rates are useless.

It would be foolish to gauge success of one’s digital marketing campaign based on any of these metrics. (*Harsh language used intentionally to get the point across.*)

Two simple reasons: All of them can be manipulated. And second, even if not, they don’t signify anything of value.

So, what should you measure?

Conversions. Or, in simpler words: Results.

If you are doing a list building or a lead generation campaign, just measure how many records or leads got generated. If you are doing a webinar promotion, measure how many registered or attended. If you are promoting a white paper, measure how many people downloaded the form to fill it.

Smart marketers use the metrics like impressions, clicks, and CTR% to study the funnel and improve conversions at each stage to increase the end-result, but they never compare a campaign or a platform based on these parameters. **EFY**